



Plug in or else...

Web OS on the other hand runs off a remote server. What actually runs on the computer is merely an interface which could even be something as basic as a web browser. All your data is saved on a remote server too. Your computer will require a smaller hard disk and less RAM and still run everything from word processors to spreadsheets, to games, to photo editors, to instant messaging and a whole lot more.

Since all a cloud OS needs is just something to serve as an interface, quite a few work clean out of a browser, giving new meaning to working on the go. Just find any old computer anywhere in the world with an internet connection and log in. Everything you were working on will be right where you left it- even if you choose to access it using your smartphone.

With cloud OSes, even ancient computers can become relevant again. The only catch when it comes to cloud OSes is the fact that you will constantly be connected to the internet. Which will be a problem in both the current scenario as well as the near future as with more users coming on board, the demand for faster, stabler connections will rise. The same will also enable heavier programmes developed for normal OSes to run off the cloud. Seeing that the speeds available to the rest of the world is yet to catch up South Korea's, it's definitely in the horizon. Only problem is that nobody can accurately tell where that lies.

What are the available choices?

Since this entire Fasttrack is on the Chrome OS, the first one on the list is the Chrome OS, but because we have an entire issue to talk about it, let's look at what else is available.

Jolicloud

Currently in its second iteration- Jolicloud 2, Jolicloud is developed by a French company of the same name which was started in 2009. While Joli-